

Derek Etzler

UX Designer

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UX designer completing a Bachelor of Applied Science in User Experience at Full Sail University, building on a foundation in graphic design and web development. Research-driven and detail-oriented, with nine self-directed and client case studies spanning mobile app concepts, game UX, and a real business platform — comfortable owning a project from problem definition through wireframes, prototyping, and testing. Brings 11+ years of experience leading crews through high-stakes, safety-critical operations, with an instructor's habit of turning complex procedure into something anyone can follow.

SELECTED UX WORK

Keep Going First Aid — [Client Project](#). Designed the class-registration flow and three role-based dashboards (student, instructor, owner) for a real CPR/first-aid training business, unifying very different daily needs into one coherent platform.

Kroger AR Shopping Concept — [App Concept](#). Designed AR “scan-to-identify” and in-store navigation features for a grocery app concept, layered onto a familiar browse-and-shop flow and presented as an interactive Figma prototype.

Ocean-Friendly Choices — [App Concept](#). Designed and prototyped a mobile app helping everyday shoppers make sustainable seafood choices before they buy, built and tested end-to-end in Figma.

Eternal Grove Guardians — [Game UX Concept](#). Led UX for an action-RPG concept: built two user personas from competitive research, then designed a full onboarding sequence and in-game UI system around their needs.

EDUCATION

Full Sail University — Bachelor of Applied Science, User Experience	In Progress — Exp. 2026
Full Sail University — Associate of Science, Graphic Design	2023
Full Sail University — Associate of Science, Web Design & Development	2020

SKILLS

UX / RESEARCH	VISUAL DESIGN	WEB & PROFESSIONAL
User research	Adobe Photoshop	HTML, CSS, JS fundamentals
Wireframing & prototyping (Figma)	Adobe Illustrator	Responsive design
Usability testing	Visual design systems	Cross-functional communication
Information architecture	Typography	Training & instruction
Persona development		Crisis decision-making

PROFESSIONAL BACKGROUND

Firefighter / Lieutenant (fill-in) — U.S. Department of Defense & U.S. Air Force

Fort Leonard Wood, MO • Fort Cavazos, TX • Fort Stewart, GA • NAS Kingsville, TX • Scott AFB, IL

- Led crews of three or more through high-stakes, time-critical emergency operations across five installations over 11+ years, including a multi-day wildland fire response and aircraft crash-rescue operations.
- Certified Fire Instructor — trained and mentored personnel, translating technical procedure into clear, teachable steps.
- Communicated precisely with cross-functional teams, hospital staff, and command under pressure, and served as fill-in Lieutenant when needed.
- Recognized with a Commander's Award for life-saving action during a cardiac-arrest emergency.